

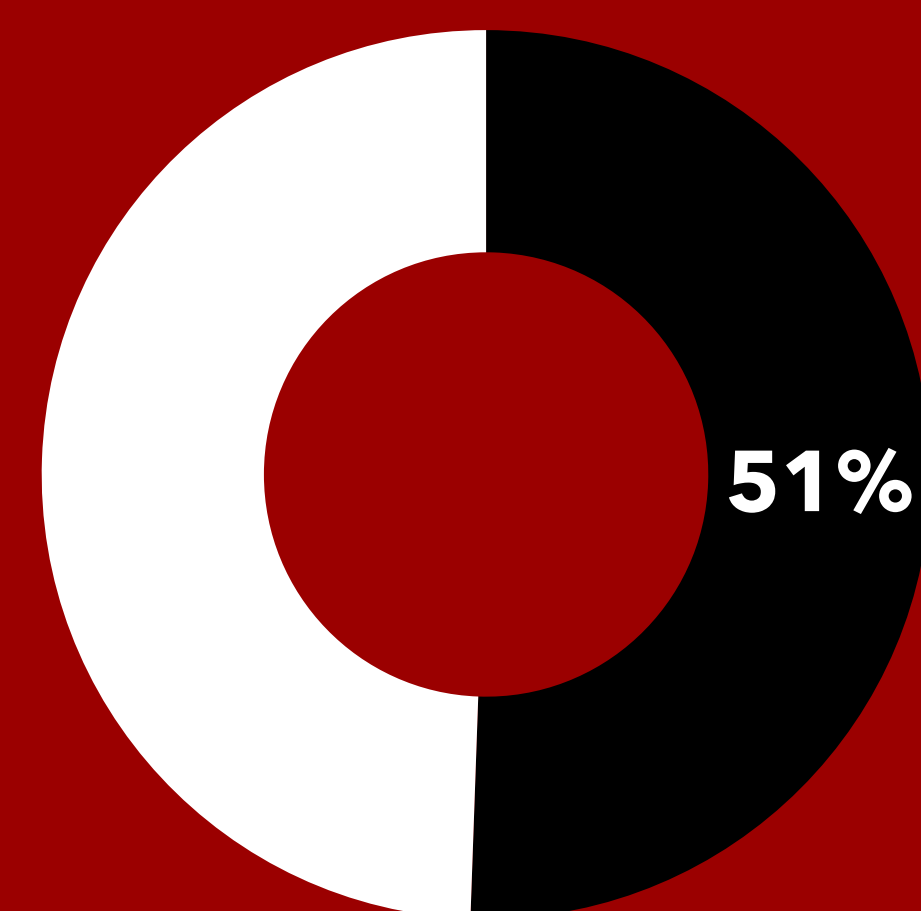
DON'T ARGUE WITH COPS?

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"F***ing thugs with guns
that don't uphold the
United States Constitution."^[1]
- *Michael Wood*
...right **before**
being arrested

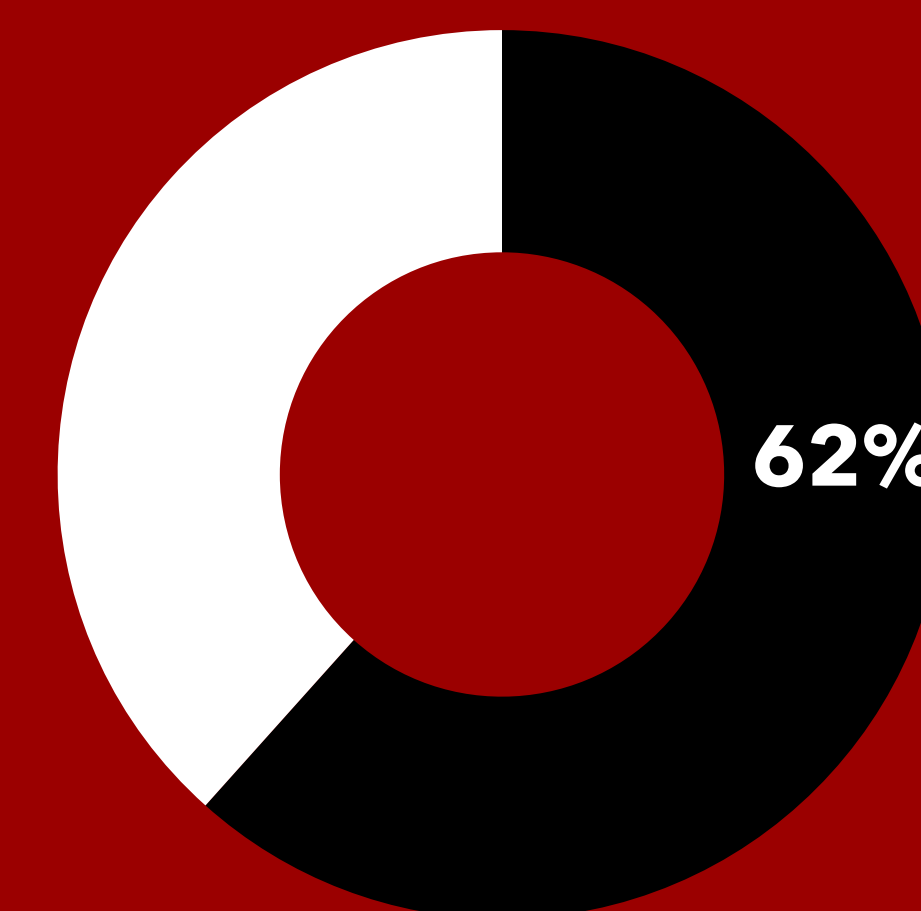
1996-2001 [2]

Majority of "fighting words"
cases from 1996-2001 involved
police confrontations:



We found the
same for cases
2021-2026:

2021-2026



The harms of "fighting words"

Chilling

effect on free speech causing
people to self-silence

Silencing

of further criticism and violent
interruption of testimony

Nullifying

constructive illocutionary
intent by deeming words are
"no essential part of any
exposition of ideas"^[3]

[1] *Wood v. Eubanks* (2022)

[2] Caine, B. (2004). The trouble with "fighting words": *Chaplinsky v. New Hampshire* is a threat to first amendment values and should be overruled. *Marquette Law Review*, 88 (3)

[3] *Chaplinsky v. New Hampshire* (1942)